

# CRM Sync – Shopify App Platform Changes

For product managers, operations, and business stakeholders. **Apps built under the old rules fail submission under the new requirements** – legacy Partner Dashboard apps, non-expiring access tokens, and undeclared field-level customer-data access all need updating before publication or re-review.

For: Product managers, operations teams, and business stakeholders tracking Shopify app compliance

Date: 2026-05-18

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## THE PROBLEM

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Shopify has fundamentally changed how apps are built, authenticated, and reviewed. Apps built under the old rules will fail submission under the new requirements – and some deadlines have already passed.

If your app was created in the legacy Partner Dashboard, uses non-expiring access tokens, or manages customer data without declaring specific field-level access, it needs to be updated before it can be published or pass re-review.

These are not optional enhancements. They are platform requirements with enforcement dates.

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WHAT CHANGED

| AREA                 | OLD WAY (PARTNER DASHBOARD)                  | NEW WAY (DEV DASHBOARD)                                                          | DEADLINE                                         |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Access tokens        | Never expire — store once, use forever       | Expire every 60 minutes — must refresh automatically                             | April 1, 2026<br>(mandatory for new public apps) |
| Customer data access | Request "read customers" → get everything    | Request specific fields: name, email, phone, address — each justified separately | Enforced on submission                           |
| App configuration    | Web forms in dashboard — no version history  | Config file in code repository — version controlled, reviewable                  | Current standard                                 |
| GDPR compliance      | Optional checkbox for data deletion webhooks | Mandatory — must handle data requests, customer deletion, and shop deletion      | Enforced on submission                           |
| Consent management   | Not required by platform                     | Customer Privacy API required — consent signals before data collection           | 2025-2026 enforcement                            |
| Billing              | REST API for charges                         | GraphQL API for subscriptions with upgrade/downgrade support                     | Current standard                                 |
| App review           | Submit and wait weeks for opaque feedback    | AI-assisted self-review, structured submission, test credentials required        | April 2026                                       |
| Extensions           | Created and managed in web dashboard         | Managed via command-line tool, stored in code repository                         | Current standard                                 |
|                      |                                              |                                                                                  |                                                  |
|                      |                                              |                                                                                  |                                                  |

CRM SYNC – CURRENT COMPLIANCE STATUS

| REQUIREMENT                                                 | STATUS | NOTES                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| App registered in Dev Dashboard                             | Done   |                                                          |
| Config file ( <code>shopify.app.toml</code> ) in repository | Done   |                                                          |
| Expiring tokens with automatic refresh                      | Done   | Refreshes before expiry, not after failure               |
| GDPR deletion webhooks implemented                          | Done   | All three handlers with signature verification           |
| Privacy policy published                                    | Done   | Hosted at <code>crm-sync-docs.netlify.app</code>         |
| Protected customer data level requested                     | Needed | Must request Level 1 (name + email) in Partner Dashboard |
| GDPR webhooks declared in config file                       | Needed | Verify in <code>shopify.app.toml</code>                  |
| Billing via GraphQL                                         | Needed | Not yet implemented                                      |
| Minimum required scopes verified                            | Needed | Audit for unnecessary permissions                        |
| App listing complete                                        | Needed | Screenshots, demo video, test credentials                |
| Emergency contact provided                                  | Needed | Email + phone for Shopify review team                    |

KEY DATES

| DATE                            | WHAT HAPPENS                                      | WHAT YOU NEED TO DO                                                           |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Already passed<br>(Feb 2025)    | Scopes reviewed for necessity on every submission | Remove any permissions the app doesn't actively use                           |
| Already passed<br>(Dec 2025)    | Customer data scopes enforced for tracking pixels | Pixels accessing customer data need field-level approval                      |
| Already passed<br>(Apr 1, 2026) | Expiring tokens mandatory for new public apps     | Apps with never-expiring tokens will be rejected – CRM Sync already compliant |
| Current (Mar 2026)              | Role-based access for partner organizations       | Multi-user partner orgs need role setup                                       |
| Current (Apr 2026)              | New submission experience with AI self-review     | Pre-submission automated checks flag common issues                            |

WHAT EACH CHANGE MEANS FOR YOUR BUSINESS

Expiring Tokens

**Before:** Your app got a permanent key to the store's data. If that key was ever leaked, it worked forever.

**Now:** Keys expire every 60 minutes and must be refreshed. This means:

- A leaked key stops working within an hour
- The app must handle refresh automatically (CRM Sync does this)
- Both the old key and the new key must be updated together on each refresh

**Business impact:** Better security with no change in functionality. But apps that don't implement refresh will simply stop working.

## Protected Customer Data

**Before:** Request "read customers" and get everything – names, emails, phones, addresses.

**Now:** You must declare exactly which customer fields you need and justify why. There are three levels:

- **Level 0:** No customer personal data (just orders, products)
- **Level 1:** Name and email (required for CRM Sync's identity matching)
- **Level 2:** Plus phone and address (needed if syncing to CDPs that use phone/address)

**Business impact:** CRM Sync needs at least Level 1. Testing must happen on a real store (not a development store) because development stores bypass these restrictions.

## Mandatory GDPR Webhooks

**Before:** Handling data deletion requests was optional.

**Now:** Your app must handle three specific requests from Shopify:

1. "Give us all the data you have for this customer" (data access request)
2. "Delete this customer's personal data" (deletion request)
3. "This store uninstalled your app – delete all their data within 48 hours" (shop deletion)

**Business impact:** CRM Sync already handles all three. Each request is verified for authenticity before processing.

## Configuration as Code

**Before:** App settings lived in web forms. No history, no review process, no way to compare versions.

**Now:** Settings live in a file ( `shopify.app.toml` ) in the code repository. Changes are version-controlled and reviewable.

**Business impact:** You can see exactly what changed, when, and who approved it. Same config file is used across development and production.

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## MIGRATION CHECKLIST

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For teams migrating from the old Partner Dashboard to the current Dev Dashboard:

### Authentication:

- ☐ Implement expiring token refresh (60-minute access tokens, 90-day refresh tokens)
- ☐ Test that the app recovers from an expired token without errors
- ☐ Verify the app works in Chrome incognito mode (no pre-existing cookies)

### Customer Data:

- ☐ Request the appropriate data access level (Level 1 or 2) in Partner Dashboard
- ☐ Verify the app handles missing/null fields gracefully (for unapproved fields)
- ☐ Test on a non-development store (dev stores bypass field restrictions)

### GDPR Compliance:

- ☐ Implement all three data handling webhooks (data request, customer deletion, shop deletion)
- ☐ Verify each webhook checks request authenticity before processing
- ☐ Declare webhook URLs in the config file
- ☐ Publish a privacy policy and link it from the app listing

## Billing:

- ☐ Switch to GraphQL subscription API
- ☐ Test billing with test mode enabled on development store
- ☐ Disable test mode before submitting for review
- ☐ Support plan upgrades and downgrades without reinstalling

## App Listing:

- ☐ App icon (1200x1200px)
- ☐ 3-6 screenshots (1600x900px) showing actual app UI
- ☐ Demo screencast with English or English subtitles
- ☐ Test credentials that the review team can use
- ☐ Emergency contact email and phone number

## Configuration:

- ☐ Generate or create `shopify.app.toml` with correct settings
- ☐ Set API version to current supported version (2025-04 or later)
- ☐ Disable legacy install flow
- ☐ List only the minimum required permission scopes

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## DOWNLOADABLE AUDIT CHECKLIST

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A comprehensive checklist covering all 10 requirement areas (100+ items) is available for download:

**File:** `docs/shopify-app-checklist.11m.md`

This checklist can be:

- Used as a team tracking document for submission readiness

- Fed to an AI assistant alongside your codebase for automated compliance checking
- Added to your pull request template for team review before each release

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*Technical reference: FEATURE-SPEC-UA-MIGRATION.md Audit checklist: shopify-app-checklist.llm.md*

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